



ENGLISH EDITION

Automatic Pond Aeration

The complete user manual

Control and monitor a pond aeration system with ioBroker — from your very first step.

WARNING **WARNING — please read before you start**

This adapter is **still under development** and **not yet verified for unattended use**. It controls a **life-support system for living animals**. A malfunction, a wrong setting or a bug can stop the aeration and **endanger the health and life of your fish** (oxygen depletion, no ice-free hole in winter, an overheating pump). **Do not rely on it unchecked:** watch it closely, verify every function on your own hardware, and keep an independent, proven aeration/failsafe in place. **Use at your own risk.**

ADAPTER

ioBroker.automatic-pond-aeration

VERSION

v0.0.14

DATE

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Contents

1 Welcome	3
1.1 What this adapter does	3
1.2 Who should read which part	3
2 How a pond aeration works (the basics)	5
2.1 The physical parts	5
2.2 Why aeration matters for the animals	5
3 Safety concept (the most important chapter)	6
4 What you need	7
5 Installing the adapter	8
6 Configuring the adapter, tab by tab	9
6.1 General	9
6.2 Aeration points	9
6.3 Groups	9
6.4 Control	9
6.5 Sensors	10
6.6 Location	10
6.7 Feeder	10
6.8 Safety	10
6.9 Notifications	10
7 Using the adapter day to day	11
8 Data points reference	12
9 Hardware & wiring (reference build)	13
9.1 Controller board	13
9.2 Reference sensors (all optional)	13
10 FAQ	14
11 Troubleshooting	15
12 References	16

1 Welcome

This manual explains the **ioBroker.automatic-pond-aeration** adapter from the ground up. It is written for readers with **no prior knowledge** — if you have never used ioBroker and have never wired a valve, you are in the right place. By the end you will be able to install the adapter, connect it to your aeration hardware, configure it safely, and operate it from your phone or computer.

1.1 What this adapter does

A pond aeration pushes air from a pump through hoses to **air stones (diffusers)** on the pond floor. The rising bubbles add oxygen and keep the water moving. This adapter decides **when** and **where** the air flows, by opening and closing **valves** — one valve per *aeration point* (up to 8). It can:

- switch the aeration points by a **weekly schedule**, a **cyclic sequence** (round-robin over points and/or groups), or in **groups**;
- protect the pump with a **safety interlock** so it never runs against closed valves;
- optionally **monitor** dissolved oxygen, air/water temperature and air-line pressure, and raise alarms;
- keep an **ice-free hole** in winter and **boost aeration when oxygen is low**;
- **pause** the aeration while your fish are being fed (coupling to the automatic-feeder adapter);
- send **notifications** (e.g. Telegram) and collect **runtime statistics**.

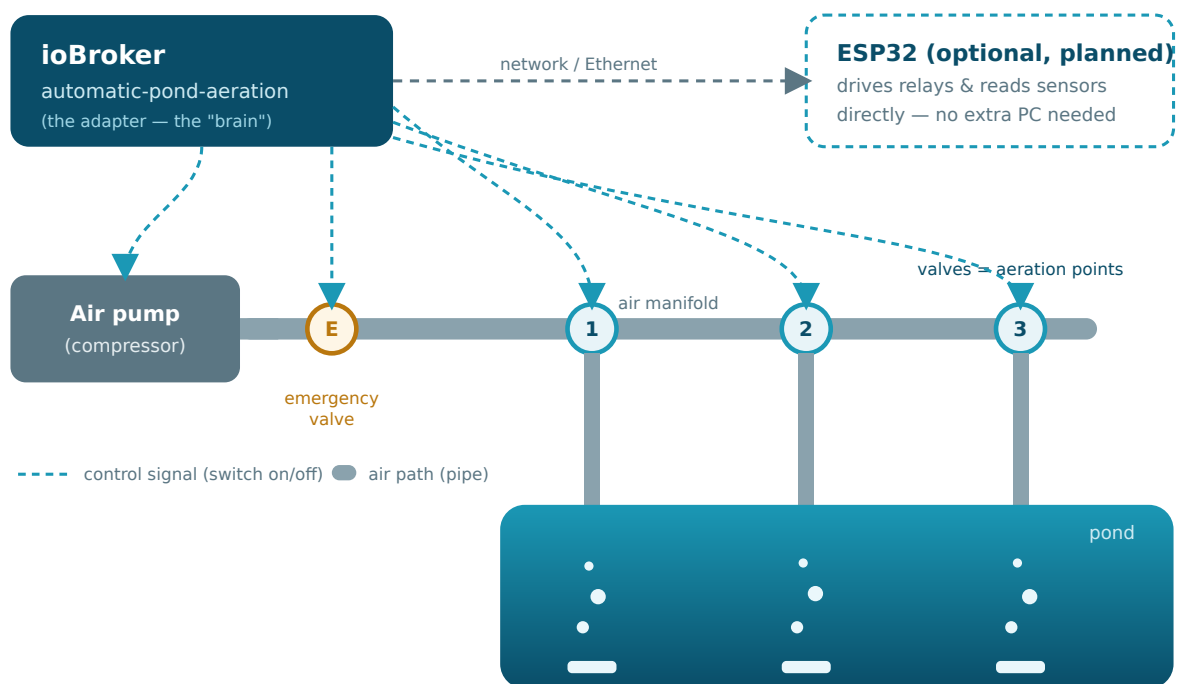


Figure 1: How the parts fit together: the adapter (the “brain”) decides which valves open; the pump feeds air through the manifold; each open valve sends air to one diffuser in the pond. The direct ESP32 path is planned [3].

1.2 Who should read which part

- 1 **Just want to understand it?** Read chapters 1–3.

- 2** **Setting it up?** Follow chapters 4–6 in order.
- 3** **Operating it day to day?** Chapter 7 and the FAQ (chapter 10).
- 4** **Something not working?** Jump to Troubleshooting (chapter 11).

2

How a pond aeration works (the basics)

Even if this is all new to you, the idea is simple.

2.1 The physical parts

Air pump / compressor

Manifold + hoses	Distribute the air to several points in the pond.
Valves (solenoids)	One per aeration point. Open = air flows to that diffuser; closed = it doesn't. These are what the adapter switches.
Diffusers / air stones	Turn the airflow into fine bubbles under water.
Emergency valve	A safety relief so the pump always has somewhere to blow, even if every normal valve is closed.

2.2 Why aeration matters for the animals

Fish and pond life need **dissolved oxygen** in the water. Warm summer nights, algae and decaying matter can deplete it; a thick ice sheet in winter traps toxic gases. Aeration adds oxygen, mixes the water, and — in winter — keeps a small **ice-free hole** open so gases can escape ^[2]. Because the animals depend on it, **reliability and safety come first** — which is why this adapter is built around a hard safety interlock (chapter 3).

3

Safety concept (the most important chapter)

An air pump must **never run against fully closed valves** (“dead-heading”): the pressure has nowhere to go, the pump overheats and can be damaged. The adapter prevents this at all times.

SAFETY The dead-head interlock

While the pump runs, at least one valve is **always kept open** (you set the minimum). If that cannot be guaranteed, the adapter **opens the emergency valve** and — if the pump is controllable — **switches the pump off**.

Two more safety mechanisms work alongside it:

- **Make-before-break switching:** when the aeration moves from one point to the next, the new valve opens **before** the old one closes, so there is never a moment with everything shut.
- **Watchdog:** the interlock is re-checked on a short timer, not only when something changes.

TIP Wiring recommendation

Use a **normally-open (NO)** emergency valve, so it opens by itself on a power cut — a true failsafe. When you later run the hardware on an ESP32, the same interlock also runs **on the device**, so a network or ioBroker outage cannot harm the pump ^[3].

4 What you need

An ioBroker installation

[1]

Node.js ≥ 22

Required by the adapter.

At least one switchable valve

Reachable in ioBroker as a **state** — e.g. from a relay board, smart plug or KNX/Zigbee actuator. The adapter switches these existing states.

Optional

A controllable pump, an emergency valve, and sensors for oxygen / temperature / pressure — see chapter 9.

NOTE No ioBroker yet?

Install ioBroker first (see the official documentation [\[1\]](#)). It runs on a Raspberry Pi, a NAS, a small PC or a virtual machine. Once the ioBroker admin opens in your browser, come back here.

5 Installing the adapter

- 1 Open the **ioBroker admin** in your browser (usually `http://<your-server>:8081`).
- 2 Go to **Adapters**, click the **GitHub / custom install** icon (the cat/octocat), and enter the repository URL `https://github.com/ssbingo/ioBroker.automatic-pond-aeration` ^[2]. (Once the adapter is in the official repository you will simply search for “pond aeration”.)
- 3 Confirm the install and wait until it finishes.
- 4 Click **Add instance**. A new instance `automatic-pond-aeration.0` is created and its settings page opens.

OK Done

You now have an instance. Nothing is controlled yet — the **master switch** is on, but you have not told it about any valves. That is the next chapter.

6

Configuring the adapter, tab by tab

The settings page is organised into tabs. You only fill in the parts you use. Click **Save** (or **Save and close**) when you are done.

6.1 General

- **Master enable** — the on/off switch for the whole adapter. Off = nothing is controlled.
- **Dry-run (log only)** — a **test mode**: the whole logic runs and the data points update, but no real valve or pump is switched — the intended actions are only written to the log ([DRY-RUN] would ...). Perfect for trying a configuration safely before wiring it up.
- **Backend** — Existing ioBroker states (default) drives your hardware through other adapters' states. ESP32 (direct) is **planned** (chapter 9) and not active yet.

6.2 Aeration points

This is the heart of the setup. Add **up to 8** points; each one is one valve.

- 1 Click **Add point**.
- 2 Give it a **name** (e.g. "Pier", "Deep zone").
- 3 Leave **Backend** on ioBroker.
- 4 Under **Valve state**, pick the ioBroker state that opens this valve (the object browser lets you search your existing states).

SAFETY Each enabled point needs a valve state

If a point is enabled but has no state mapped, the adapter warns in the log and cannot switch it.

6.3 Groups

Group several points to control them together (e.g. one switch opens three diffusers). Give the group a name and tick its member points.

NOTE Hard rule

There can **never be more groups than points**. The admin and the adapter both enforce this.

6.4 Control

Here you decide **when** the aeration runs automatically.

- **Cyclic round-robin** — rotate through the points, each open for the **dwel time** (seconds).
 - **Sequence (points and groups)** — optionally define an **ordered cycle of steps**, where each step targets a single point **or** a whole group, with its own optional dwell time. This lets you run e.g. *group 1* → *group 3* → *point 1* → ... and freely mix points and groups. Reorder steps with the up/down arrows. An empty sequence just rotates through all points.
- **Schedules** — open selected points/groups during weekday time windows (From/To, e.g. 08:00–18:00; overnight windows like 22:00–06:00 work too). **An active schedule has priority over the round-robin / sequence.**

- **Winter / ice-free mode** — during a season you set as a recurring MM-DD window (e.g. 11-01-03-15, which correctly wraps across New Year) the chosen points are forced on to keep an ice-free hole open. Optionally tick “**only when it is cold**” and set an air-temperature threshold so the pond is only aerated while it is actually freezing (needs air-temperature monitoring). Leave the point selection empty to aerate the whole pond.

6.5 Sensors

Optional monitoring. For each sensor tick **Enabled** and pick the **source state**.

- **Dissolved oxygen** — with a low threshold (raises an alarm), a target and a hysteresis. The oxygen **saturation %** is computed from the water temperature.
 - **Oxygen closed loop** — when enabled, the adapter **forces aeration on** while the oxygen is below the low threshold, until it recovers to the target. A safety net for the fish.
- **Air / water temperature.**
- **Pressure** — with a min/max range; leaving the range raises a pressure alarm. Useful to spot a blocked diffuser (pressure rises) or a burst hose (pressure drops).

6.6 Location

Needed only for the astronomical times (sunrise/sunset/night). Choose the ioBroker system location, or enter a custom address — the map geocodes it via OpenStreetMap/Nominatim on demand [\[15\]](#).

6.7 Feeder

Pause selected aeration points while the *automatic-feeder* adapter [\[13\]](#) is feeding, so the food is not blown around. Pick the feeder instance (auto-discovered) and the switches to watch, choose a **duration mode** (measure/pulse) and an **offset** (extra pause after feeding — at least the average time the animals need to eat).

6.8 Safety

- **Min. open valves while the pump runs** — the dead-head protection (default 1).
- **Watchdog interval** and **make-before-break overlap**.
- **Pump** — whether it is controllable (then the interlock may switch it off), its state, and anti short-cycle on/off times.
- **Emergency valve** — its state, whether it is **normally open** (failsafe), the valve **type** (solenoid or motorised ball valve) and, for a motor valve, its travel time.

6.9 Notifications

Enable notifications and pick a **messaging instance** (any adapter of type `messaging`, e.g. Telegram or Pushover). The adapter then sends a short message when the safety interlock trips or clears, when the oxygen alarm raises or recovers, and when the pressure leaves or re-enters its range.

7 Using the adapter day to day

The adapter exposes **data points** (states) you can read and command — from the ioBroker admin, from scripts, or from a visualization. The most important commands:

`control.enabled`

<code>control.mode</code>	<code>auto</code> (schedules/sequence/winter/oxygen run automatically), <code>manual</code> (you open points by hand), or <code>off</code> (all closed).
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<code>control.allOff</code>	Close every valve immediately.
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<code>control.point.<n>.open</code>	Open/close one point by hand (only takes effect in <code>manual</code> mode).
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<code>control.group.<g>.active</code>	Activate a group.
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TIP How the modes interact

In `auto` mode the automatic programs (schedule, sequence, winter, oxygen boost) decide the valves; the safety interlock always runs on top, and a feeder pause always wins. In `manual` mode you are in control, but safety and the feeder pause still apply.

8 Data points reference

The adapter creates these states from your configuration. <n> = point index (0-7), <g> = group index. Items marked **(w)** are writable commands; the rest are read-only status values.

Object	Meaning
info.connection	Adapter running / configuration valid
info.activeMode	Current operating mode
info.dryRun	Dry-run active (no hardware switched)
control.enabled (w)	Master enable
control.mode (w)	auto / manual / off
aeration.point.<n>.valveState	Valve is open
aeration.point.<n>.active	Point is currently aerating
aeration.point.<n>.runtimeTodaySec / .runtimeTotalH	Runtime today / total
safety.interlockActive	Safety interlock currently active
safety.emergencyValve	Emergency valve is open
safety.openValveCount	Number of open valves
sensors.oxygen / .oxygenSaturation / .oxygenAlarm	Oxygen value / saturation % / low alarm
sensors.oxygenBoostActive	Oxygen closed loop forcing aeration on
sensors.pressure / .pressureAlarm	Pressure value / out-of-range alarm
winter.active / .frostActive	Winter mode forcing on / frost protection engaged
statistics.compressorRuntimeTodayH	Compressor runtime today
statistics.switchCyclesToday	Valve switch cycles today

9 Hardware & wiring (reference build)

Today the adapter drives your valves and pump through **existing ioBroker states**, so any relay board or smart plug works. A **direct ESP32 build** is planned so you need no extra PC — this section is the reference for that build.

9.1 Controller board

The reference controller is the **Waveshare ESP32-S3-POE-ETH-8DI-8RO** ^[3]: 8 relays (for the valves, emergency valve and pump), 8 digital inputs, and Ethernet with **Power-over-Ethernet** — one cable for power and data.

9.2 Reference sensors (all optional)

Water temperature

^[16]

^[12]

Air-line pressure

CFSensor XGZP6897D...KPDG (I²C), gauge type, 0–100 kPa default ^[7]. Only available from AliExpress/Alibaba; the firmware auto-detects the two bus variants (0x6D / 0x58).

Dissolved oxygen

Optional and costly. Budget: **DFRobot SEN0237-A** (€176) ^[6]. Premium: **Atlas EZO-DO** stack (€450) ^[4], which needs an electrical isolation carrier ^[5].

Full part numbers, prices, wiring, the I²C address map and all caveats are kept in `dev/hardware/sensors.md` in the repository.

SAFETY Oxygen sensing is maintenance-heavy

Both oxygen options use a galvanic probe with a membrane/electrolyte that must be serviced regularly and needs water flow across it. Treat oxygen as an optional, advanced add-on.

10 FAQ

Do I need an ESP32 to use the adapter? No. Today it controls valves and the pump through existing ioBroker states. The ESP32 build is a planned convenience, not a requirement.

Nothing switches — did I break something? Check that the **master switch** is on, the **mode** is auto (or manual with a point opened), and each enabled point has a **valve state** mapped. In **dry-run** nothing is switched by design.

Can I run just a winter ice-free hole? Yes. Enable **Winter / ice-free mode** with your season window and (optionally) frost protection, and leave the automatic schedule empty.

Is oxygen monitoring required? No, it is fully optional — and the most expensive, most maintenance-heavy part. Many ponds run fine on a schedule plus the safety interlock.

Will it keep my fish safe on its own? Not yet — see the warning on the cover. It is still in development. Always supervise it and keep an independent failsafe.

11 Troubleshooting

The admin page is empty / old

Address search says “no address found”

The adapter **instance** must be running to answer the lookup, and it must be an up-to-date version. Start the instance and retry.

The safety interlock keeps tripping

The pump is seen as running while too few valves are open. Check the pump state mapping, raise the number of scheduled/open points, or verify the emergency valve wiring.

Oxygen reading looks wrong

Feed the sensor the **water temperature** (it compensates on that), make sure there is **flow** across the probe, and check the membrane/electrolyte. Cheap clones drift badly.

Pressure value jumps around

Humid air can condense on the pressure sensor. Mount it above the manifold with a dead-leg and a moisture trap, barb pointing down ^[7].

If you are still stuck, open an issue on the project repository ^[2] with your adapter version, your configuration and the relevant log lines (set the instance log level to `debug`).

12

References

- [1] ioBroker — official documentation — <https://www.iobroker.net/#en/documentation/>
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- [12] cpetrich/counterfeit_DS18B20 — how to spot fakes — https://github.com/cpetrich/counterfeit_DS18B20
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- [15] OpenStreetMap Nominatim — geocoding usage policy — <https://operations.osmfoundation.org/policies/nominatim/>
- [16] BerryBase — DS18B20 waterproof probe (reputable EU source) — <https://www.berrybase.de/ds18b20-ic-digitaler-temperatursensor-wasserdicht>